Demilich

What Lies beyond Lichdom

Habitat: Any; **Treasure:** Arcana

A demilich is a skull harboring the remnants of a lich's wicked essence. If the burden of immortality overwhelms a lich, its consciousness turns inward as its body rots away. But if its remains are disturbed, a demilich rises. Demiliches usually appear as skulls adorned with gems or arcane sigils.

Demilich Lairs

Demiliches jealously guard their deathtrap-laden sanctums. The most notorious of these is the Tomb of Horrors, lair of the infamous Acererak.

The region containing a demilich's lair is twisted by its presence, creating the following effects:

Enervating Domain. Whenever a creature other than the demilich or one of its allies finishes a Long Rest within 1 mile of the lair, the creature must succeed on a DC 20 Constitution saving throw or have its Hit Point maximum reduced by 1d4. This reduction lasts until the creature finishes a Long Rest outside that area.

Travel Ward. Creatures can't use teleportation or planar travel to enter or exit the lair.

If the demilich dies or moves its lair elsewhere, these effects end immediately.

Demilich

Tiny Undead, Neutral Evil

AC 20 **Initiative** +17 (27)
HP 180 (72d4)
Speed 5 ft., Fly 30 ft. (hover)

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
Str	1	−5	−5	**Dex**	20	+5	+11	**Con**	10	+0	+6
Int	20	+5	+11	**Wis**	17	+3	+9	**Cha**	20	+5	+5

Resistances Bludgeoning, Piercing, Slashing
Immunities Necrotic, Poison, Psychic; Charmed, Deafened, Exhaustion, Frightened, Paralyzed, Petrified, Poisoned, Prone, Stunned
Senses Truesight 120 ft.; Passive Perception 13
Languages None
CR 18 (XP 20,000, or 22,000 in lair; PB +6)

Traits

Legendary Resistance (3/Day, or 4/Day in Lair). If the demilich fails a saving throw, it can choose to succeed instead.

Undead Restoration. If the demilich is destroyed, it reforms and regains all its Hit Points in 1d10 days unless a *Wish* spell is cast on its remains.

Actions

Multiattack. The demilich makes three Necrotic Burst attacks.

Necrotic Burst. *Melee or Ranged Attack Roll:* +11, reach 5 ft. or range 120 ft. *Hit:* 24 (7d6) Necrotic damage.

Howl (Recharge 5–6). *Constitution Saving Throw:* DC 19, each creature in a 30-foot Emanation originating from the demilich. *Failure:* 70 (20d6) Psychic damage. *Failure or Success:* The target has the Frightened condition until the start of the demilich's next turn.

Legendary Actions

Legendary Action Uses: 3 (4 in Lair). Immediately after another creature's turn, the demilich can expend a use to take one of the following actions. The demilich regains all expended uses at the start of each of its turns.

Energy Drain. *Constitution Saving Throw:* DC 19, one creature the demilich can see within 120 feet. *Failure:* The target's Hit Point maximum decreases by 14 (4d6). *Failure or Success:* The demilich can't take this action again until the start of its next turn.

Grave-Dust Flight. The demilich flies up to its Fly Speed, shedding grave dust. Each creature within 5 feet of the demilich as it moves is targeted once by the following effect. *Constitution Saving Throw:* DC 19. *Failure:* The target has the Blinded condition until the end of the demilich's next turn. *Failure or Success:* The demilich can't take this action again until the start of its next turn.

Necrosis. The demilich makes one Necrotic Burst attack.

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